

NIRMAAN MODEL UNITED NATIONS 2026

Moot Court

AGENDA:

A courtroom where logic prevails, advocacy defines, and every case demands more than just words.

August 8-9, 2026 | Delhi NCR | Indraja Foundation
<https://linktr.ee/nirmaan.indraja>

1. COMMITTEE OVERVIEW

The Moot Court simulates appellate court proceedings. Unlike traditional MUN committees, Moot Court requires legal reasoning, courtroom advocacy, and mastery of procedure.

IMPORTANT: The specific case will be provided on the day of the event. Prepare by familiarizing yourself with the legal framework and advocacy skills below.

FORMAT:

- Teams of 2 (Speaker 1 + Speaker 2) per side
- Petitioner (Appellant) vs Respondent
- Each speaker gets designated time for arguments
- Judges may interrupt with questions at any time
- Rebuttal and sur-rebuttal rounds

2. AREAS OF LAW TO PREPARE

CONSTITUTIONAL LAW (INDIA):

- Fundamental Rights · Articles 14 (Equality), 19 (Freedoms), 21 (Right to Life and Personal Liberty)
- Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV)
- Fundamental Duties (Article 51A)
- Constitutional Remedies · Article 32 (Supreme Court), Article 226 (High Courts)
- Basic Structure Doctrine (Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala, 1973)

KEY LANDMARK JUDGMENTS:

- Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India (1978) · Expanded scope of Article 21
- Vishaka v. State of Rajasthan (1997) · Sexual harassment guidelines
- Navtej Singh Johar v. Union of India (2018) · Decriminalization of Section 377
- K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India (2017) · Right to Privacy as fundamental right
- Indian Young Lawyers Association v. State of Kerala (2018) · Sabarimala case

INTERNATIONAL LAW (if applicable):

- Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1948)
- ICCPR and ICESCR
- Customary International Law principles
- ICJ Statute, Article 38 · Sources of international law

3. MEMORIAL STRUCTURE

A memorial is the written submission to the court. Standard format:

I. COVER PAGE · Court name, case title, team details

II. TABLE OF CONTENTS

III. INDEX OF AUTHORITIES · Cases, statutes, books, articles cited

IV. STATEMENT OF JURISDICTION · Why this court has jurisdiction

V. STATEMENT OF FACTS · Neutral, chronological summary (no arguments here)

VI. STATEMENT OF ISSUES · Framed as questions of law

VII. SUMMARY OF ARGUMENTS · Brief overview (1 paragraph per issue)

VIII. ARGUMENTS ADVANCED · Detailed legal reasoning with authorities

IX. PRAYER FOR RELIEF · What you're asking the court to do

FORMATTING:

- 12pt Times New Roman, 1.5 line spacing
- Pages numbered, authorities in proper legal citation format
- Keep to page limits strictly

4. ORAL ADVOCACY TIPS

STRUCTURE YOUR ARGUMENT:

1. Begin with "May it please the Court" · introduce yourself and your side
2. Present a brief roadmap of your arguments
3. Address each issue systematically
4. Conclude with a clear prayer/request

COURTROOM ETIQUETTE:

- Stand when addressing the bench
- Address judges as "My Lord" / "Your Lordship" or "Your Honour"
- Never interrupt the bench · pause and answer questions immediately
- Maintain composure under pressure
- Do not read from your memorial · speak from notes

HANDLING BENCH QUESTIONS:

- Listen carefully to the complete question
- If you don't know, say "I will address that shortly" · then DO address it
- Use questions as opportunities to strengthen your argument
- Never argue with the bench · respectfully disagree with reasoning

5. EVALUATION CRITERIA

MEMORIAL (if applicable): 30%

- Knowledge of facts and law
- Quality of legal reasoning
- Proper citation and formatting
- Persuasiveness of arguments

ORAL ARGUMENTS: 70%

- Knowledge of law and application to facts (25%)
- Oral advocacy skills and persuasion (20%)
- Response to bench questions (15%)
- Courtroom demeanor (10%)

AWARDS:

- Best Memorial
- Best Speaker (Petitioner)
- Best Speaker (Respondent)
- Best Team